

ALLIANCE FOR COLLECTIVE EMPOWERMENT

ACE

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

“We are not asking for a seat at the table. We are building our own.”

Léandre Poplus, Founder

THE VISION

The Alliance for Collective Empowerment (ACE) is a 25-year initiative to establish a network of self-governing, self-sustaining cities for Black and Native American communities on tribal land across the United States protected by tribal sovereignty law, funded by community capital, and governed by a constitutional framework designed to last generations.

ACE is not a program. It is not a nonprofit initiative. It is not a political campaign. It is the architectural blueprint for an independent civilization with its own cities, schools, hospitals, economy, and governing constitution built by two of the most historically dispossessed peoples in American history, for themselves, on their own terms.

ACE has been designed with its predecessors in mind. The destruction of the Freedmen’s Bureau, the 1921 Tulsa Race Massacre of the Greenwood District, the dismantling of Five Civilized Tribes’ pre-statehood governments, and the FBI’s COINTELPRO program all form a documented pattern of resistance to Black and Native self-governance at its moment of greatest success. Every legal protection, constitutional provision, and sovereignty clause in this Act exists because ACE has studied that history and built accordingly.

THE STRATEGIC LOGIC

Native Americans hold tribal sovereign land territory not subject to standard U.S. municipal law, state taxation, or federal zoning. This is the legal and territorial foundation no other community in America can offer.

Black Americans hold \$1.6 trillion in annual spending power the investment capital, consumer base, and labor force that turns sovereign land into a functioning economy.

Together: sovereign land + capital + population = an independent, self-governing civilization. Neither community can build this alone. Both can build it together.

THE SCALE

Target population

32 million

Black Americans (planning figure)

Pioneer population target

300,000

Phase 3 milestone — proof of concept

Phase 1 land commitment

150,000 acres

Released in 25,000-acre milestone increments

Long-range land footprint

24M acres

National network @ 0.75 acres/resident

Development horizon

25 years

Four phases

City network target

10+ cities

Across 5 regions, multiple tribal partners

THE TRIBAL PARTNERSHIP

ACE's legal foundation is tribal sovereignty the most durable legal protection available on American soil, having survived 200 years of federal attempts to dismantle it. ACE enters 70-to-99-year land leases with federally recognized tribal nations under the HEARTH Act of 2012, operating as a Tribally Chartered Entity that extends sovereign immunity to all ACE community operations.

Priority tribal targets: The Navajo Nation (17.5M acres across Arizona, New Mexico, and Utah) is the primary scale partner. Secondary targets include the Cheyenne River, Pine Ridge, Standing Rock, and Wind River reservations for their land scale and sovereignty strength; and the Cherokee, Seminole, Muscogee, and Lumbee nations for their documented historical relationships with Black Americans.

The Tribal Partnership Agreement includes a political transition protection clause: ACE agreements survive changes in tribal leadership and bind all successor governments, with a mandatory 60-day consultation period before any amendment proceedings may begin. ACE retains tribal sovereignty counsel on 24-hour retainer for this specific contingency.

Native agricultural sovereignty: The ACE Agricultural Cooperative assigns not less than 51% equity to the Tribal Partner, recognizing tribal nations as the senior agricultural partners whose generational land knowledge is the foundation of ACE food production. The ACE Farming Academy trains Black farmers under tribal agricultural faculty.

THE FOUR PHASES

PHASE 1 Years 0-2 The Movement

Form ACE legal entities. Recruit Native American Co-Chair the most urgent pre-institutional act. Forge tribal partnerships. Build national grassroots awareness. Secure founding capital.

PHASE 3 Years 7-15 The City

Scale to 300,000 pioneer residents. All municipal systems operational, governance, courts, hospital, university, media, economy.

PHASE 2 Years 2-7 Territory

Execute first Tribal Partnership Agreement. Break ground. Build water, energy, roads, homes. Launch clinic, school, ACE Credit Union, agricultural cooperative.

PHASE 4 Years 15-25 Civilization

10+ ACE cities nationally. ACE University system. \$50B+ annual economy. International trade with Africa and Caribbean. 32M served.

WHAT ACE BUILDS - THE FULL SYSTEM

Housing

Lease-to-own on tribal land. ACE-CPF Housing Account builds equity automatically. Zero Homelessness Mandate.

Education

K–12 through ACE University. BIE-approved. Pan-African and Indigenous studies at every grade. Tuition-free for ACE residents.

Healthcare

Community clinic to full hospital. MediSave-funded no medical debt. Modern medicine co-equal with Indigenous and African traditional healing. Black maternal mortality eliminated by design.

Economy

ACE owns infrastructure layer. Free enterprise above it. Majority Lending Institution network. ACE Economic Solidarity Culture builds internal dollar circulation.

Governance

Three-branch government. ACE Community Assembly, Executive Council, Community Court. Co-equal tribal co-governance. ACE Governing Charter as supreme law.

Public Safety

Tiered peacekeeping. 60% of calls handled by unarmed community care responders. Restorative justice replaces incarceration as default.

Food & Energy

80% halal food establishments. Swine prohibition on all ACE land and no swine as domestic pets. 51% tribal-majority agricultural cooperative. Full energy independence.

Media & Culture

ACE Media Network: TV, podcast, print, streaming. ACE Culinary Archive preserves and evolves Black and Native food traditions. Community-owned narrative.

THE ACE SOCIAL CONTRACT

Every ACE resident who works and contributes is guaranteed four things by retirement age:

- A home they own, free and clear, within ACE Territory funded through the ACE Community Provident Fund Housing Account
- A retirement income sufficient to live with dignity funded through the ACE-CPF Retirement Account
- Comprehensive healthcare for themselves and their dependents, without debt funded through the ACE MediSave Program and ACE Community Shield catastrophic pool
- Free education for their children, from early childhood through university within the ACE school system

This is the promise ACE makes. Not as aspiration. As architecture.

COMMUNITY HEALTH POLICY

ACE's food standards are grounded in public health evidence, not governance control or religious doctrine. Black Americans experience cardiovascular disease at 60% higher rates, diabetes at 77% higher rates, and hypertension at the highest rates of any demographic group all directly linked in peer-reviewed literature to diets high in processed pork and saturated fat. Native Americans experience type 2 diabetes at more than twice the national average. ACE corrects these outcomes by design on its own land.

The Nation of Islam has made this precise health argument for over 80 years. Elijah Muhammad's foundational work identified pork consumption as a primary driver of the chronic disease burden in Black communities' decades before the epidemiological literature confirmed it. ACE's food policy vindicates that long-standing position and welcomes the Nation of Islam as a founding partner in the ACE Food Health Initiative.

The ACE Food Standards: 80% of food establishments halal-certified. No swine of any kind raised, kept, or produced on ACE land. No swine kept as domestic pets. Pork available only in the 20% non-halal commercial tier, sourced exclusively from tribal farmers. All ACE institutions, schools, hospital, government buildings are pork-free without exception.

FUNDING PHILOSOPHY

The U.S. government is responsible for the conditions ACE corrects. Federal grants are a supplementary instrument never the foundation. ACE is funded by its community:

- Major donor investment from high-net-worth Black and Native American individuals structured as named infrastructure commitments, not charity. Tier 0 outreach: President Barack Obama, approached as Counselor before any other contact.
 - Community Investment Bonds from \$500 entry point turning every community member into a co-owner
 - ACE infrastructure enterprise revenue from energy, agriculture, broadband, and land leases the two-stream funding model that sustains community services without resident taxation
 - ACE Economic Solidarity Culture: dollar circulation rate tracked and published quarterly; ACE Loyalty Network makes choosing ACE businesses economically advantageous in the immediate term
-

THE POLITICAL DEMAND

The Black American Tax Equity Initiative (BATEI) demands that Congress extend the same federal tax exemption status to Black Americans operating within ACE Community Development Zones that it has already extended to Native American tribes. The U.S. government has accepted the principle that a government responsible for the dispossession of a people owes them remedial recognition in law. It has applied that principle to tribal nations. It has not applied it to Black Americans, despite identical moral and legal logic. ACE asks for equal application of a principle already accepted.

The ACE Congressional Caucus is ACE's independent political accountability network not a caucus within Congress but an external endorsement body that holds elected officials accountable to ACE communities and supports primary challenges when endorsed members drift. ACE forms all its own institutions. It does not partner with or channel its agenda through existing political caucuses whose institutional entrenchment has compromised their independence.

THE FUTURE IS OURS. LET'S BUILD IT.

The full ACE Act - 20 Titles - is enclosed.

Léandre Poplus, Founder - Alliance for Collective Empowerment